

THE ENVIRONMENTAL DAMAGE OF URBAN SPRAWL CANNOT BE IGNORED

URBAN SPRAWL

IN CONTEXT

KEY FIGURE

Robert Bruegmann (1948–)

BEFORE

1928 British architect Clough Williams-Ellis compares London's growth to an octopus devouring the countryside.

1950s With postwar prosperity and increased car ownership in the US, the middle classes leave cramped city centers and move to new, low-density areas in the suburbs.

AFTER

2017 A housing crisis in the UK prompts calls for the lifting of restrictions on new building on the greenbelts around major UK cities.

2050 The date by which, according to UN estimates published in 2014, the urban population of the world is set to rise to 6.34 billion out of a projected total population of 9.7 billion.

Since the 1950s, the term "urban sprawl" has been widely used to describe the growth of low-density suburbs beyond high-density city cores. The term was first used by *The Times* newspaper in the UK in 1955 to describe the spread of London's suburbs. At this time, the British planning authorities